Two trials at the Old Bailey

1885 • Whiteley's, Westbourne Grove

845. GEORGINA LOUISA RYAN, Stealing 1½ yards of ribbon, the property of William Whiteley.

Mr. Grain *Prosecuted;* Messrs Edward Clarke, Q.C., *and* Besley *Defended.*

Margaret Willsford. I am employed by Mr. Whiteley—on 11th July a sale commenced in several departments—I was engaged in the ribbon department with a great many others—I know the prisoner as a casual customer in my department for about 18 months—on 11th July she came to my counter and took up a piece of ribbon value 2¾*d.*—each piece is ticketed with the length and the price—I think she gave me a shilling in payment—I wrapped it in paper—we always put the amount we receive on the bottom of the bill, which is in duplicate, and give it to a cash boy, who takes it to the cashier, and then brings the change back to me with the stamped bill, and we then give it to the customer—I did that with reference to Mrs. Ryan on that occasion—while the cash boy was going to the desk I noticed the prisoner rolling some pieces of ribbon very tight in her hand, and when the boy came back with the change she dropped them in the box from which she had taken them—I was

...

Cross-examined. I have heard that Whiteley's men called regularly at her house.

John Walter Jupe. I am dissecting clerk at Whiteley's, I analyse the bills—I produce all the bills for all sales from the two desks in the ribbon department—there is no bill for the sale of a piece of ribbon at 1*s.* 11½*d.* on 22nd July.

Cross-examined. Miss Paine would pay into desk 53—the 505 on this bill is the number of the assistant—I cannot tell you the number of the bills in each of these bundles—I do not think the assistants sometimes put the goods of different customers on the same bill.

The prisoner received an excellent character. Not Guilty.

1895 • De Selincourt's Silk Warehouse

NEW COURT.—*Wednesday, May 22nd,* 1895.

Before Mr. Recorder.

454. HANNAH WILSON (40) and ANN HANSTEAD (40), Stealing eighty-six yards of silk, the property of Charles De Selincourt.

Mr. Simmons *Prosecuted, and* Mr. Purcell *Defended.*

Sidney Grover. I am warehouseman to De Selincourt and Son, of ... on May 3rd the prisoners came in together,

...

there before I began to ... stuck to her dress—I tried to keep it there—Wilson said she was a respectable woman, of Hackney.

...

Guilty.—*They then both* Pleaded Guilty *to a previous conviction of a like offence in the names of Ward and Sadler at this Court on June 27th,* 1887.—*Three Years' Penal Servitude, having still a portion of their former sentence to serve.*

Proceedings of the Central Criminal Court, London